

February 2007

ViewSonic VX2245WM

Michael Browne

I've been saving up to buy a large (20.1 inch or above) widescreen LCD, and have been hunting around. That's why I just *had* to review the VX2245WM

Day 1

The VX2245WM sports a lovely piano black finish. It's glossy enough to remind me of Samsungs Bordeaux LCD TVs! The bezel is a little too wide for my taste, and makes the monitor look larger than it is which spoils aesthetic appeal. I got a call, had to run, so no setting it up today.

Day 2

Setting up the monitor was a breeze. It's got both D-Sub and DVI connectivity. On a negative note, the monitor cannot swivel sideways—generally, larger monitors have this capability.

Day 3

The VX2245WM excels at office applications—Word, Excel, etc. Of course, these applications are an overkill for this monitor and aren't really its intended genre of use. The joy of working with large excel sheets on this monitor has to be experienced to be believed. Hardly any horizontal scrolling required. Web browsing is a delight—absolutely no complaints with a screen this large. Who says a 17-inch monitor is enough for surfing?

Day 6

The VX2245WM comes with four USB ports, one upstream port (USB B type), and three downstream ports (USB A type). Convenient! Now I don't have to bend my back to insert a pendrive into my cabinet's USB ports. There are also inbuilt speakers, with a little subwoofer too. This monitor has another trick up its sleeve—it also features an iPod dock!

Day 9

I got an iPod 30 GB from a friend to try with the dock—it works perfectly. So iPod owners behold—

another reason to buy this monitor—you can tune into your Pod, and charge it, too!

Day 11

It was Saturday, and I planned a serious round of gaming on the new monitor. A couple of hours of F.E.A.R confirmed the speedy response time. I noticed some gray where there should have been pure black, and firefights in darkened corridors became a game of guess-position-and-shoot. The same thing happened with *Far Cry*—I had to turn off the lights to be able to see anything!

Day 12

I fired up a movie—*Torque*. One of my colleagues said, "Wow! Look at that—it's huge... I want!" Colour reproduction is impressive on this one!

Day 24

Time to say goodbye... I enjoyed having a large screen (don't we all?). Offering decent performance on all fronts the VX2245WM is a good buy at the price of Rs 24,000. Agreed, most users don't have such budgets for just a monitor (when entire systems have been purchased for less). Discerning gamers and professionals working with images will give it a wide berth, but for the home user who wants to turn his PC into an entertainment station and television substitute will have one less component to decide on.

michael_browne@thinkdigit.com

